Technical and Business Writing

Mid Long Questions (4 marks each) · Easy answers matched to the slides and notes

#	Long question	Source	Priority
1	Writing Situation: Audience, Purpose, Context	Unit 1 · Lecture 1 · Lecture 2	Must do
2	7 Cs of Communication	7 Cs notes	Must do
3	Email Writing	Lecture 1 · Class work	Must do
4	General vs Technical vs Business Writing	Lecture 1 · Unit 1	Backup
5	Technical Writing Process	Lecture 2 · Unit 1	Backup

How to write a 4-mark long: Introduction (1–2 lines) → Table or points → One example → Conclusion (1 line).

LONG 1: Writing Situation (Audience, Purpose, Context)

Unit 1 (1.2) · Lecture 1 (slides 5, 20–21) · Lecture 2 (slide 7)

Q. Explain the writing situation: audience, purpose and context.

Introduction

Before writing, a writer must answer **three questions**. This is called analysing the **writing situation**. It is the habit that separates good technical writers from average ones.

1. Audience: Who will read this?

Readers differ in what they **know** and what they **need**. There are 4 types:

Audience	What they want
Experts	Data, methods and evidence
Technicians	Clear steps and specifications
Managers	Summary, cost, risks and a recommendation
Laypeople / Clients	Plain explanation and benefits

2. Purpose: What should the reader do after reading?

- **Inform:** explain what happened (e.g. progress report)
- **Instruct:** tell how to do something (e.g. installation guide)
- **Persuade:** convince someone to approve or change (e.g. proposal)

3. Context: Where and how will it be read?

On a phone, printed in a meeting, or beside a machine? Is it urgent? Context decides the **length, layout and tone**.

Example: same facts, different readers

- **To the developer:** "The login API fails because the session table has no index."
- **To the manager:** "Students cannot log in. A fix will take two days and cost nothing extra."

Both are correct. Each is right for its reader.

Conclusion: Knowing the audience, purpose and context helps the writer give the **right information** in the **right way**.

Yaad karne ki trick: Kaun parhega? (Audience) · **Kyun** likh raha hoon? (Purpose) · **Kahan/kaise** parhega? (Context)

LONG 2: 7 Cs of Communication

7 Cs notes (Mind Tools)

Q. Explain the 7 Cs of communication with examples.

Introduction

The 7 Cs are a **checklist** that makes sure our emails, meetings, reports and presentations are **clear and effective**.

C	Meaning	Example
1. Clear	The goal is clear; the reader does not have to guess	Say which Daniel and what you want
2. Concise	Short and to the point; no filler words	Remove "kind of", "definitely", "basically"
3. Concrete	Clear details and facts	"Pack a healthy lunch in 1 minute"
4. Correct	No grammar or spelling mistakes; fits the audience	"two-**week**" not "two-**weak**"
5. Coherent	Logical; one email = one topic	Don't mix report feedback with a meeting reminder
6. Complete	All needed information + a call to action	Give the meeting **time and place**
7. Courteous	Polite and friendly; no insults	"Could my team get extra time, please?"

Conclusion: Using the 7 Cs as a checklist makes communication clear and builds **credibility** with clients, bosses and colleagues.

Yaad karne ki trick: Saaf · Chhota · Pakka · Sahi · Jura · Poora · Tameez
(Clear · Concise · Concrete · Correct · Coherent · Complete · Courteous)

LONG 3: Email Writing

Lecture 1 (slides 13–14) · Class work · 7 Cs

Q. What is a professional email? Explain its parts and write an example.

Introduction

A business email is the **main daily medium** for professional communication inside and outside an organization. A good email is **clear, polite and to the point**.

Parts of a professional email

Part	What to write
1. Subject line	Short and clear: what the email is about
2. Salutation	Polite greeting: "Dear Sarah,"
3. Purpose	First line says why you are writing
4. Details	Needed facts: dates, times, names
5. Request / Action	What you want the reader to do, with a **deadline**
6. Closing	"Thank you," + your name

Unprofessional vs Professional (slide 14)

Unprofessional:
Subject: report
Hey, I need the project report ASAP. Send it over now.
Defects: rude tone, no deadline, no salutation, does not say which report.

Professional:
Subject: Request: Updated Sprint 4 Progress Report
Dear Sarah,
Please send the updated Sprint 4 progress report by 3:00 PM today so we can review it before the client meeting.
Thank you,
Alex
Strengths: clear subject, polite salutation, exact deadline, explains the reason.

Conclusion: A professional email follows the **7 Cs**: clear, concise, complete and courteous.

Yaad karne ki trick: S-S-P-D-R-C: "**S**ubject, **S**alaam, **P**urpose, **D**etails, **R**equest, **C**losing"

If the paper says "Write an email to…": use these same 6 parts and only change the topic.

LONG 4: General vs Technical vs Business Writing

Lecture 1 (slides 6, 11, 15–16) · Unit 1 (1.1)

Q. Differentiate between general, technical and business writing.

Definitions

- **Technical writing:** conveys **complex technical information clearly and accurately** to a **specific audience**.
- **Business writing:** professional communication **within or between organizations** to share information and **support decisions**.

General vs Technical writing

Basis	General Writing	Technical Writing
Purpose	To entertain or express feelings	To inform, instruct or solve problems
Audience	General public	Specific readers (developers, users)
Tone	Emotional, creative	Objective, factual, clear
Structure	Flexible, story-like	Headings, lists, tables
Vocabulary	Creative words	Precise technical terms

Technical vs Business writing

Basis	Technical Writing	Business Writing
Focus	Systems, software and data	Decisions, operations and relationships
Documents	API docs, SRS, user manuals	Emails, memos, proposals
Reader	Developers, technicians, users	Managers, clients, executives

Overlap: technical proposals and feasibility reports belong to **both**.

Conclusion: All three are different, but a computing professional needs both **technical and business writing**.

Yaad karne ki trick: General = **dil** ki baat · Technical = **system** ki baat · Business = **faisle** ki baat

LONG 5: Technical Writing Process

Lecture 2 (slides 4–5) · Unit 1 (1.5)

Q. Explain the stages of the technical writing process.

Introduction

Good technical writing does not start by randomly typing paragraphs. Writers follow a **process**.

Stage	What happens
1. Idea	Identify the topic, problem or need
2. Planning	Decide audience, purpose, scope and information needed
3. Information Gathering	Find and collect the needed information
4. Reviewing	Check relevance, accuracy and currency
5. Organizing	Group and order the information (outline)
6. Drafting	Turn the plan into readable content
7. Revising & Finalizing	Improve content, language and presentation

The process is iterative: a later stage may show missing information, so the writer goes **back** to an earlier stage. It is a **cycle of improvement**, not a straight line.

Example: while drafting a cloud-migration report, the writer finds cost data missing and goes back to gathering information.

Conclusion: Following the process produces a **clear, accurate and well-organized** document.

Yaad karne ki trick: "**I**dea **P**lan **G**ather **R**eview **O**rganize **D**raft **R**evise" → "**I**k **P**akistani **G**har **R**aat **O**r **D**in **R**oshan"